RECENT REAL · 10.10.2026 · 2-SMENA

Writing Task 1

You are a student at a local university. You received an email from the university library manager.

Dear Student,

We are writing to inform you about some changes to our university library. Due to plans to improve the study facilities, the library will be transformed into a self-study centre. The renovation work is expected to take approximately one month, and the new centre will reopen after this period. To compensate for the temporary closure, all students will receive one month of free membership.

Before making the final arrangements, we would like to hear your opinions. How do you feel about transforming the library into a self-study centre? What facilities or services would you like the new centre to offer? Do you have any suggestions for supporting students during the renovation period?
Thank you for sharing your thoughts.

Kind regards,
The University Library Manager

Task 1.1 — Informal letter
Write a letter to your friend, who is also a student at the university, telling them about the proposed changes, explaining how you feel about them, and suggesting what the university should do.
Write about 50 words.

Task 1.2 — Formal letter

Write a letter to the university library manager explaining your feelings about transforming the library into a self-study centre and suggesting facilities or services that should be provided.

Write 120–150 words.

Writing Task 2

Variant A

You are participating in an online discussion about education and modern technology. The question is:

Some people believe that online education is more effective than traditional classroom learning, while others argue that face-to-face education provides better learning opportunities.

Post your response, discussing both views and giving reasons and examples. Write 180-200 words.

Variant B

Some people believe that studying online is as effective as studying in a classroom, while others argue that students learn better in a physical school.

Post your response, discussing both views and giving reasons and examples. Write 180-200 words.

Model answers

SAMPLES FOR SELF-STUDY — TRY TO WRITE YOUR OWN ANSWER FIRST.

Task 1.1 · B2 level (50 WORDS)

Hi Sara,

The library is going to become a self-study centre, and it will be closed for a month. I think it's a good idea because it will be quieter, but I'm worried about our exams. The university should open a temporary reading room. What do you think?

Bye, Ali

Task 1.1 · C1 level (47 WORDS)

Hi Sara,

Did you hear? The library is being turned into a self-study centre and will close for a month. Although I welcome the upgrade, the timing is awkward with exams approaching. The university really ought to provide a temporary reading room. What's your view?

Cheers, Ali

Task 1.2 · B2 level (136 WORDS)

Dear Library Manager,

I am writing about your email on the plan to change the library into a self-study centre.

In my opinion, this is a good idea because many students need a quiet place to study alone. I am also happy that we will get a free month of membership. However, I am a little worried about a month without the library, especially when many students are preparing for exams.

I would like to suggest some facilities for the new centre. First, it should have comfortable desks and good lighting. It would also be useful to have fast Wi-Fi, charging points and a small café. Finally, the centre could stay open late at night during exam periods.

During the renovation, the university could offer a temporary study room in another building.

Yours faithfully, Ali Karimov

Task 1.2 · C1 level (136 WORDS)

Dear Library Manager,

I am writing in response to your email regarding the proposed transformation of the library into a self-study centre.

Overall, I strongly support the idea. Many students struggle to find a quiet environment for independent work, and a dedicated space would address this need. I also appreciate the free month of membership, although I am slightly concerned about the timing of the closure, as many of us will be revising for exams.

As for facilities, I would recommend ergonomic desks with proper lighting, reliable high-speed Wi-Fi and plenty of charging points. Bookable group rooms and a small café would also be extremely valuable. Moreover, extended opening hours during exam periods would be greatly appreciated.

In the meantime, perhaps the university could provide a temporary reading room in another building.

Yours faithfully, Ali Karimov

Task 2 (A) · B2 level (194 WORDS)

Technology has changed the way we study, and many people ask whether online lessons are better than classes in a school building.

Supporters of online education say that it is more flexible. Students can learn at any time and from any place, so they save money and time on travelling. They can also repeat recorded lessons as many times as they need and choose from courses taught by excellent teachers around the world. For instance, a student in a village can follow an English course from a famous university.

On the other hand, face-to-face education has important strengths. Teachers can see immediately when a student is confused and can explain again in a different way. Students talk to each other, work in groups and learn communication skills that are difficult to practise on a screen. It is also easier to stay focused in a classroom without phones and other distractions.

In my opinion, the best results come from a mixture of both. Online tools are very useful for homework and extra practice, while real lessons give motivation and personal support. Therefore, schools should combine the two methods instead of choosing only one of them.

Task 2 (A) · C1 level (184 WORDS)

The debate over whether online education outperforms the traditional classroom is a defining one for modern schooling, and the honest answer is that each excels in different respects.

Advocates of online learning highlight its accessibility and adaptability. Learners in remote regions can reach world-class instruction, and self-paced platforms let them revisit difficult material until it is mastered. For motivated adults juggling work and study, this flexibility is invaluable. Cost matters too: online courses are frequently cheaper, widening access to people who could never afford to relocate.

Nevertheless, face-to-face teaching offers something screens struggle to replicate. Immediate feedback, spontaneous discussion and the structure of a shared timetable sustain motivation, especially among younger students who lack self-discipline. Online learners, by contrast, must supply that self-control themselves. Classrooms also nurture collaboration and social confidence, which are as vital as academic knowledge.

In my view, effectiveness depends less on the medium than on the learner and the quality of teaching. Consequently, a blended model, in which digital resources reinforce in-person guidance, seems the most sensible compromise, combining convenience with the human connection that genuine learning so often requires.

Task 2 (B) · B2 level (189 WORDS)

Nowadays many students can choose between studying online and attending a physical school, and opinions about the two are very different.

Some people think that online study is just as effective as a classroom. Students have access to videos, exercises and tests at any time, and they can work at their own speed. Those who live far from a good school get the same lessons as everyone else, and this saves travel costs. In addition, online platforms usually record every lesson, so a student who is ill can catch up easily.

Others believe that students learn better in a real school. A teacher can check the work, give quick feedback and keep everyone disciplined. Also, schools give young people a chance to make friends, join clubs and take part in sports, which online study cannot offer. Many students find it hard to concentrate at home because of noise and mobile phones.

Personally, I think online study can work well for adults and self-motivated learners, but children usually need the structure and support of a physical school. A combination of both would probably be the most useful for most students.

Task 2 (B) · C1 level (194 WORDS)

Whether studying online can truly match the classroom experience is a question that has become unavoidable in recent years.

Those who answer in the affirmative note that digital platforms can deliver content just as effectively as a lecture hall. Recorded lessons, interactive exercises and instant assessments allow learners to progress at their own pace, and the absence of a commute frees up valuable study time. Technology has also made online assessment more reliable than it once was, narrowing the gap in results.

Sceptics, however, maintain that a physical school provides advantages no software can fully reproduce. Constant supervision, face-to-face interaction and the routine of attending lessons help students stay engaged, while extracurricular activities develop teamwork and resilience. Results alone, in any case, do not capture the personal development that school life encourages. Furthermore, many learners find it surprisingly difficult to resist distractions at home.

On balance, I believe that the answer varies with the student. Mature, self-disciplined learners may thrive online, whereas younger pupils generally benefit from the guidance and community of a school. Ideally, education systems should offer flexible, blended options so that every learner can choose the format that suits them best.